



The Grange, Priory Lane

London, SW15 5JQ

FLOOD RISK REVIEW

For Change of Use from Office (Class E) to residential (Class 3) under a Permitted Development Application

On behalf of Knight Frank

9552-TGR-RGP-XX-XX-RP-D-0500

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TABLE of CONTENTS

1 INTRODUCTION 1
2 DEVELOPMENT PROPOSAL 2
2.1 Proposed Development 2
2.2 Statutory Authorities and Consultation 2
3 PLANNING POLICY 3
3.2 National Planning Policy Framework 3
3.3 Local Development Plans 4
4 PLANNING POLICY CONTEXT 6
4.2 Flood Zones 6
4.3 Flood Risk Vulnerability Classification 8
4.4 Flood Risk Vulnerability and Flood Zone Compatibility 9
5 FLOOD RISK 11
5.1 Flood Risk Review Summary 11
5.2 Flooding from Rivers and seas 11
5.3 Flooding from Surface Water 11
5.4 Flooding from Groundwater 12
5.5 Historical Flooding Records 12
5.6 Flooding from Sewers 12
6 FLOOD RISK MITIGATION 13
6.1 Flood Risk Assessment Summary 13
6.2 Mitigation 13
6.3 Drainage 13
6.4 Access and Escape 13
7 CONCLUSION 14
APPENDIX 1 Location Plan

List of Tables

Table 1 - Statutory Authorities and Stakeholders 2
Table 2 - Flood Zones 6
Table 3 - Flood Risk Vulnerability Classification 8
Table 4 - Flood Risk Vulnerability and Flood Zone Compatibility 9
Table 5 - Flood Risk Assessment Summary 11

List of Figures

Figure 1 - Flood Map for Planning 6
Figure 2 – Surface Water Flooding (Flood Map for planning) 12

1 INTRODUCTION

1.1.1 RGP has been commissioned by Knight Frank (the 'Client') to provide a flood risk review to support proposals for a change of use of the existing Grange building from the current use as office (Class E) to residential (Class C3) under a Permitted Development (PD) application.

1.1.2 The site area is approximately 0.7Ha.

1.1.3 This Flood Risk Review has been prepared in a proportionate way to demonstrate the existing flood risk and how this is managed in accordance with the proposed change of use of the planning application.

1.1.4 The flood risk review has been prepared to document the level of flood risk and illustrate that the development is not at risk from flooding.

2 DEVELOPMENT PROPOSAL

2.1 Proposed Development

2.1.1 The proposed scheme is a change of use from office to residential under Class MA Permitted Development Rights.

2.1.2 Appendix A includes a drawing illustrating the location.

2.2 Statutory Authorities and Consultation

2.2.1 The following statutory authorities and stakeholders are applicable to this site as shown in Table 1:

Table 1 - Statutory Authorities and Stakeholders

Function	Stakeholder	Abbreviation
Executive Public Body	Environment Agency	EA
Lead Local Flood Authority (LLFA)	London Borough of Wandsworth	LBW
Internal Drainage Board	N/A	-
Planning Authority	London Borough of Wandsworth	LBW

2.2.2 Consultation with statutory authorities has not been undertaken in the production of this report.

3 PLANNING POLICY

3.1.1 The proposed development will be designed in accordance with the requirements as set out in the National Planning Policy Framework, Flood risk and coastal change planning practice guidance (PPG)[1], and local plans and polices as follows:

3.2 National Planning Policy Framework

3.2.1 The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) sets out the government's planning policies for England. Section 18 (updated 17/08/2026) covers the topic of managing flood risk and coastal change[2]. The objective of the policies in this chapter is to minimise risks to development arising from all sources of flooding and coastal change, taking into account the impacts of climate change, by steering development away from areas of risk, ensuring that development will be safe for its lifetime without increasing flood risk elsewhere, and incorporating sustainable drainage systems where appropriate.

3.2.2 With regards to planning decision making and flood risk, the NPPF sets out the following key policies:

- F4.1. To inform the assessment of flood risk and, where relevant, appropriate mitigation, a site-specific flood risk assessment should accompany all development proposals in Flood Zones 2, 3a, and 3b as defined in Annex F, table 1.

- F4.3. Site-specific flood risk assessments should be appropriate to the scale, nature, and location of development and should, where relevant, support an assessment of whether a development proposal satisfies the sequential and exception tests set out in policies F5 and F6.

- F7.1. Development proposals should not present a risk from flooding to potential occupiers, users, or visitors, and should not increase flood risk elsewhere.

- F7.2. Where development is proposed in a location known to be at risk from any form of flooding, now or in the future, it should be refused unless:

    a. Within the site, the most vulnerable development is located in areas of lowest flood risk, unless there are overriding reasons which justify a different arrangement;

    b. The development will be safe throughout its lifetime taking account of the vulnerability of its users;

    c. Any residual risk can be safely managed, and safe access and escape routes are included where appropriate, as part of an agreed emergency plan;

    d. The development is appropriately flood resistant and resilient such that, in the event of a flood, it could be quickly brought back into use without significant refurbishment; and

    e. It can be demonstrated that flood risk will not be increased elsewhere.

- F8.1. Development proposals which could affect drainage on or around the development site should incorporate sustainable drainage systems to control flow rates and reduce volumes of runoff, in ways which are proportionate to the nature and scale of the proposal. The systems employed should provide multifunctional

[1] https://www.gov.uk/guidance/flood-risk-and-coastal-change
[2] https://www.gov.uk/guidance/national-planning-policy-framework

benefits where possible, facilitating improvements in water quality, biodiversity and amenity.

3.3 Local Development Plans

3.3.1 The Mayor of London's London Plan 2021[3], adopted March 2021, is the Spatial Development Strategy for Greater London. It sets out a framework for how London will develop over the next 20-25 years and the Mayor's vision for Good Growth. The Plan is part of the statutory development plan for London, meaning that the policies in the Plan should inform decisions on planning applications across the capital. Borough's Local Plans must be in 'general conformity' with the London Plan, ensuring that the planning system for London operates in a joined-up way and reflects the overall strategy for how London can develop sustainably, which the London Plan sets out.

3.3.2 The policies relevant to flood risk and drainage are *Policy SI 12 Flood risk management*.

Policy SI 12 Flood Risk Management

3.3.3 Current and expected flood risk from all sources (as defined in paragraph 9.12.2) across London should be managed in a sustainable and cost-effective way in collaboration with the Environment Agency, the Lead Local Flood Authorities, developers and infrastructure providers.

a. Development Plans should use the Mayor's Regional Flood Risk Appraisal and their Strategic Flood Risk Assessment as well as Local Flood Risk Management Strategies, where necessary, to identify areas where particular and cumulative flood risk issues exist and develop actions and policy approaches aimed at reducing these risks. Boroughs should cooperate and jointly address cross-boundary flood risk issues including with authorities outside London.

b. Development proposals should ensure that flood risk is minimised and mitigated, and that residual risk is addressed. This should include, where possible, making space for water and aiming for development to be set back from the banks of watercourses.

c. Developments Plans and development proposals should contribute to the delivery of the measures set out in Thames Estuary 2100 Plan. The mayor will work with the Environment Agency and relevant local planning authorities, including authorities outside London, to safeguard an appropriate location for a new Thames Barrier.

d. Development proposals for utility services should be designed to remain operational under flood conditions and buildings should be designed for quick recovery following a flood.

e. Development proposals adjacent to flood defences will be required to protect the integrity of flood defences and allow access for future maintenance and upgrading. Unless exceptional circumstances are demonstrated for not doing so, development proposals should be set back from flood defences to allow for any foreseeable future maintenance and upgrades in a sustainable and cost-effective way.

f. Natural flood management methods should be employed in development proposals due to their multiple benefits including.

[3] https://www.london.gov.uk/programmes-strategies/planning/london-plan/london-plan-2021

Wandsworth Local Plan 2023-2018

3.3.4 The policy relevant to flood risk is LP12 Water and Flooding (Strategic Policy) Flood Risk Management

A. All planning applications will need to clearly demonstrate that the proposals avoid or reduce contributing to all sources of flooding, including fluvial, tidal, surface water, groundwater, flooding from sewers; take account of climate change (including predicted future changes), and would not increase flood risk elsewhere.

B. Development will be guided to areas of lower risk, both on-site and by applying the 'Sequential Test' unless already passed under part E below, as set out in national policy guidance, and where required, the 'Exception Test'. Inappropriate developments and land uses will be refused in accordance with national policy and guidance, and the Council's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA).

C. In flood zones 2 and 3, all planning applications (or other relevant applications) on sites of 10 or more dwellings or 1000sqm of non-residential development or more, or on any other proposal where safe access/egress cannot be achieved, a Flood Emergency Plan must be submitted.

D. Where a Flood Risk Assessment is required, applicants will be required to demonstrate that their proposal does not increase, and reduces surface water, fluvial and/or tidal flood risk elsewhere by ensuring that:

1) Any loss of fluvial flood storage within the 1 in 100 plus appropriate climate change allowance flood extent must be compensated for on a level for level, volume for volume basis. Proposals must demonstrate that fluvial flood flow routes are not impeded.

2) In undefended tidal areas there is no increase in built footprint or raising of ground levels. Where water compatible structures are acceptable, such as pontoons or slipways, they must be designed to minimise the loss of flood storage i.e. floodable, hollow structures.

3) Unless exceptional circumstances are demonstrated for not doing so, opportunities to provide additional flood storage must be considered and be designed into the development, in addition to ensuring no loss of surface water, fluvial and/or undefended tidal flood storage.

4 PLANNING POLICY CONTEXT

4.1.1 A site-specific FRA should be carried out to demonstrate how flood risk will be managed now and over the development's lifetime, taking into account climate change and with regards to the vulnerability of its users.

4.1.2 In order to adequately consider and demonstrate how the flood risk will be managed, we need to identify what the probability is of the site flooding, what the site is going to be used for, the associated flood risk vulnerability, and the compatibility between the flood risk vulnerability and the flood zones.

4.2 Flood Zones

4.2.1 Flood zones (as defined in NPPF Annex F Table 1) refer to the probability of river and sea flooding, excluding the presence of defences. The flood zone for this development has been determined from the EA 'Flood Map for Planning'[4].

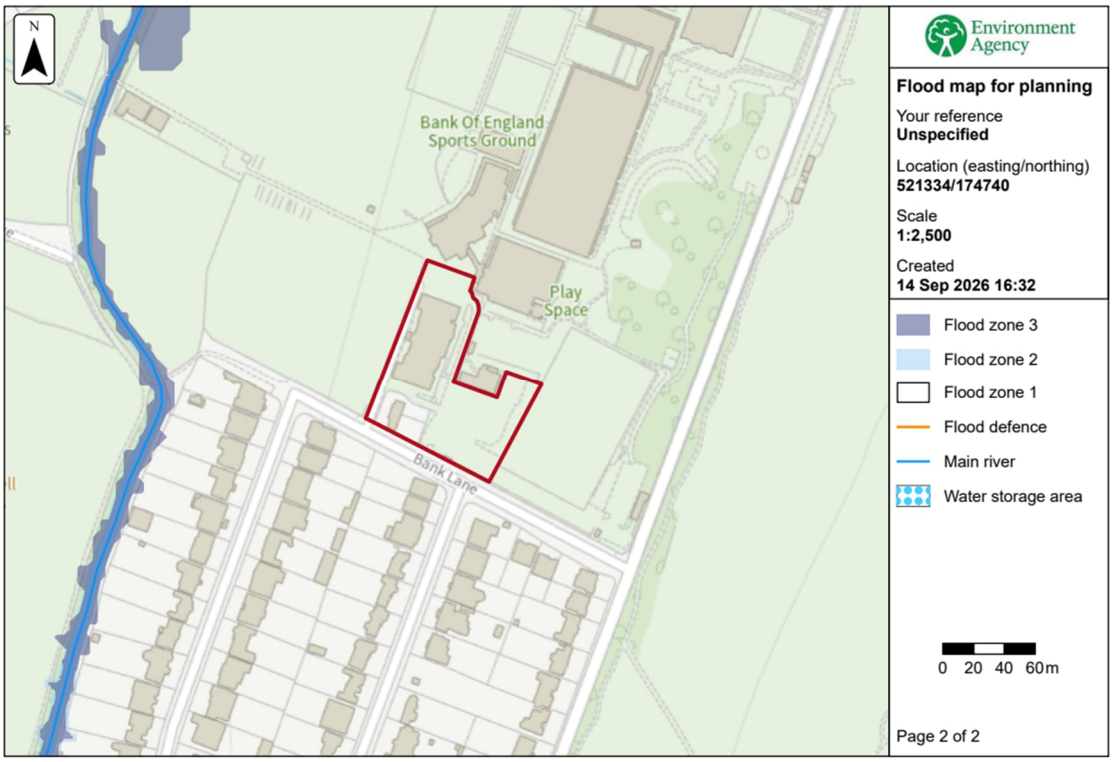


Figure 1 - Flood Map for Planning

Table 2 - Flood Zones

Flood Zone	Probability	Definition
Flood Zone 1	Low	Land which has a less than 0.1% (1 in 1,000 year) chance of flooding from rivers or the sea.
Flood Zone 2	Medium	Land which has between a 1% (1 in 100 year) and 0.1% (1 in 1,000 year) chance of flooding from rivers and between a 0.5% (1 in 200 year) and 0.1% (1 in 1,000 year) chance of flooding from the sea.
Flood Zone 3a	High	Land which has a 1% (1 in 100 year) or more chance of flooding from rivers, or a 0.5% (1 in 200 year) or more chance of flooding

[4] https://flood-map-for-planning.service.gov.uk/

		from the sea.
Flood Zone 3b	Functional Flood Plain	This zone comprises land where water has to flow or be stored in times of flood. Local planning authorities should identify in their Strategic Flood Risk Assessments areas of functional floodplain and its boundaries accordingly, in agreement with the Environment Agency. (Not separately distinguished from Zone 3a on the Flood Map)

4.3 Flood Risk Vulnerability Classification

4.3.1 The flood risk vulnerability classifications are detailed in 3 below as per Annex 3 of the NPPF.

Table 3 - Flood Risk Vulnerability Classification

Classification	Description
Essential Infrastructure	• Essential transport infrastructure (including mass evacuation routes) which has to cross the area at risk. • Essential utility infrastructure which has to be located in a flood risk area for operational reasons, including electricity generating power stations and grid and primary substations; and water treatment works that need to remain operational in times of flood. • Wind turbines.
Highly Vulnerable	• Police and ambulance stations; fire stations and command centres; telecommunications installations required to be operational during flooding. • Emergency dispersal points. • Basement dwellings. • Caravans, mobile homes and park homes intended for permanent residential use. • Installations requiring hazardous substances consent. (Where there is a demonstrable need to locate such installations for bulk storage of materials with port or other similar facilities, or such installations with energy infrastructure or carbon capture and storage installations, that require coastal or water-side locations, or need to be located in other high flood risk areas, in these instances the facilities should be classified as 'Essential Infrastructure').
More Vulnerable	• Hospitals • Residential institutions such as residential care homes, children's homes, social services homes, prisons and hostels. • Buildings used for residential houses, student halls of residence, drinking establishments, nightclubs and hotels. • Non–residential uses for health services, nurseries and educational establishments. • Landfill* and sites used for waste management facilities for hazardous waste. • Sites used for holiday or short-let caravans and camping, subject to a specific warning and evacuation plan.
Less Vulnerable	• Police, ambulance and fire stations which are not required to be operational during flooding. • Buildings used for shops; financial, professional and other services; restaurants, cafes and hot food takeaways; offices; general industry, storage and distribution; non-residential institutions not included in the 'more vulnerable' class; and assembly and leisure. • Land and buildings used for agriculture and forestry. • Waste treatment (except landfill* and hazardous waste facilities). • Minerals working and processing (except for sand and gravel working). • Water treatment works which do not need to remain operational during times of flood. • Sewage treatment works, if adequate measures to control pollution and manage sewage during flooding events are in place.

Classification	Description
Water Compatible	• Flood control infrastructure. • Water transmission infrastructure and pumping stations. • Sewage transmission infrastructure and pumping stations. • Sand and gravel working. • Docks, marinas and wharves. • Navigation facilities. • Ministry of Defence installations. • Ship building, repairing and dismantling, dockside fish processing and refrigeration and compatible activities requiring a waterside location. • Water-based recreation (excluding sleeping accommodation). • Lifeguard and coastguard stations. • Amenity open space, nature conservation and biodiversity, outdoor sports and recreation and essential facilities such as changing rooms. • Essential ancillary sleeping or residential accommodation for staff required by uses in this category, subject to a specific warning and evacuation plan.

4.3.2 The existing use of the site is for offices, which has a "less vulnerable" flood risk classification. The vulnerability classification of the site will change as a result of the development proposals and will be classed as more vulnerable.

4.4 Flood Risk Vulnerability and Flood Zone Compatibility

4.4.1 The compatibility of the development flood zone and flood risk vulnerability classification, as identified above, has been assessed in accordance with the Flood Risk and Coastal Change PPG as shown in Table 4.

Table 4 - Flood Risk Vulnerability and Flood Zone Compatibility

	Flood Risk Vulnerability Classification				
Flood Zone	Essential Infra	Highly Vulnerable	More Vulnerable	Less Vulnerable	Water Compatible
Flood Zone 1	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Flood Zone 2	✓	Exception Test	✓	✓	✓
Flood Zone 3a†	Exception Test†	×	Exception Test	✓	✓
Flood Zone 3b*	Exception Test*	×	×	×	✓*

✓ Development Appropriate

× Development Should not be Permitted

† Essential Infrastructure should be designed and constructed to remain operational and safe in times of flood

* In Flood Zone 3b (functional floodplain) essential infrastructure that has to be there and has passed the Exception Test, and water-compatible uses, should be designed and constructed to:

remain operational and safe for users in times of flood;

result in no net loss of floodplain storage;

not impede water flows and not increase flood risk elsewhere.

4.4.2 The exception test is not required for this development in accordance with Table 4 and is exempt from both the sequential and exception test as the development is appropriate with regards to flood risk vulnerability.

5 FLOOD RISK

5.1 Flood Risk Review Summary

5.1.1 A review of the risk of flooding to the development for all sources of flooding, over the lifetime of the development has been undertaken using the EA Long Term Flood Risk Mapping and the LBW SFRA. The results are summarised in Table 5 below:

Table 5 - Flood Risk Assessment Summary

Flood Risk Source	Assessed Risk Level
Rivers and Sea	Very Low
Surface Water	Very Low
Groundwater	Unlikely
Sewers	Very Low
Artificial Sources	Very Low

5.2 Flooding from Rivers and seas

5.2.1 The Flood Map for Planning states the development site is located within Flood Zone 1, as shown in Figure 1.

5.2.2 The Long Term Flood Risk Summary[5] – Rivers and Sea map shows the site has a very low yearly chance of flooding from rivers and the sea in the present day, and a very low yearly chance of flooding between 2036 and 2069. This information takes into account any flood defences.

5.2.3 A very low chance of river and sea flooding is defined less than 0.1% chance of a flood each year.

5.2.4 The lifetime risk to the development of flooding from rivers has been assessed as very *low*.

5.3 Flooding from Surface Water

5.3.1 The Flood Map for Planning shows that there is a very low chance of flooding from surface water.

5.3.2 A very low chance of surface water flooding is defined as a less than 0.1% chance of a flood each year.

[5] https://check-long-term-flood-risk.service.gov.uk/postcode,

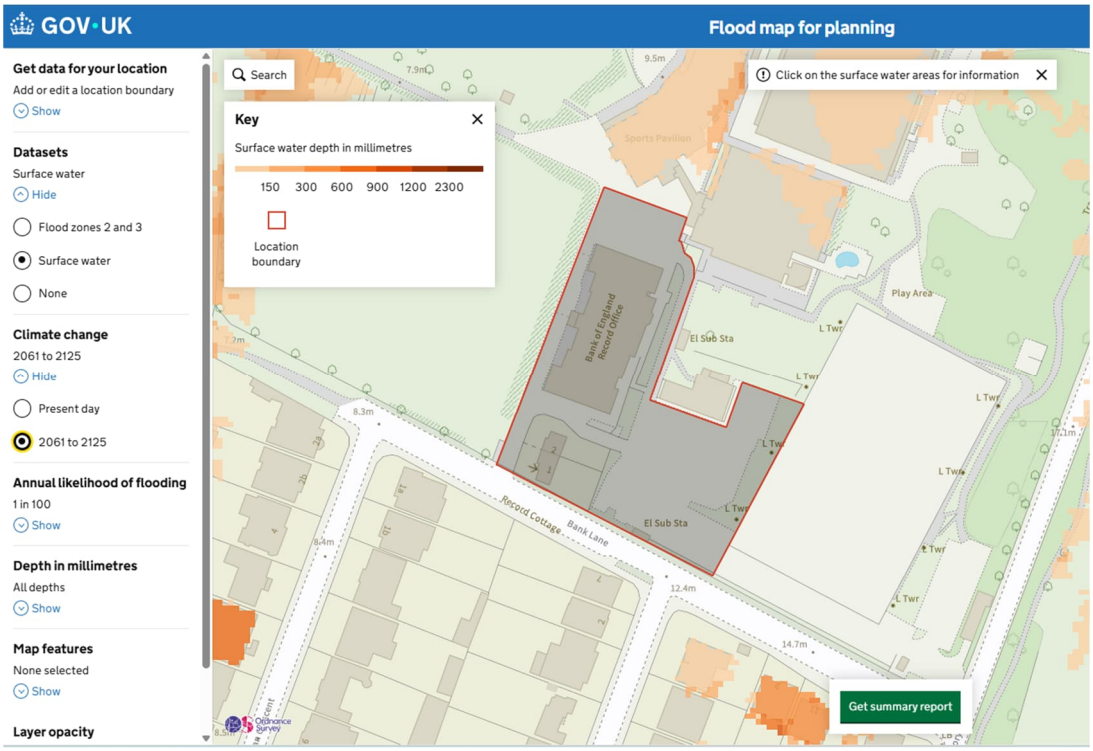


Figure 2 – Surface Water Flooding (Flood Map for planning)

5.3.3 Surface water flooding is not likely to affect this property.

5.4 Flooding from Groundwater

5.4.1 The EA Long Term Flood Risk service states this location is outside of a groundwater flood alert area.

5.4.2 The LBW Strategic Flood Risk Assessment level 1 (SFRA L1) Groundwater Map illustrates that there is potential for groundwater flooding below ground level.

5.4.3 The LBW SFRA Flooding History map does not record any localised flood Incidents within the vicinity of the site.

5.4.4 There is a basement within this property, however there are no recorded incidents of the basement flooding, there are no structural changes proposed to the basement and there is no residential accommodation proposed within the basement.

5.4.5 There the likelihood of groundwater flooding is deemed to be Unlikely.

5.5 Historical Flooding Records

5.5.1 There are no historical flooding records for this site recorded in the SFRA.

5.6 Flooding from Sewers

5.6.1 The LBW SFRA L1 Flooding History map illustrates that no properties have been affected by overloaded sewers in the postcode.

5.6.2 Flooding from sewers is therefore deemed Unlikely.

6 FLOOD RISK MITIGATION

6.1 Flood Risk Assessment Summary

6.1.1 The site specific flood risk review has considered the risk of flooding to the development for all sources of flooding, over the lifetime of the development. The results are summarised in Table 5.

6.1.2 The site has a very low flood risk from all sources over the lifetime of its development.

6.2 Mitigation

6.2.1 Given the nature of the proposal and the very low residual flood risk identified, no additional flood mitigation measures are considered necessary.

6.3 Drainage

6.3.1 The development application does not affect the drainage on or around the site, so therefore in accordance with policy F8 of the NPPF an assessment of the drainage is not required.

6.4 Access and Escape

6.4.1 The development is not located within the estimated defended flood extents, and therefore a flood emergency access and escape plan is not required.

7 CONCLUSION

7.1.1 A flood risk assessment has been undertaken to assess the level of risk over the lifetime of the development from all sources of flooding.

7.1.2 The site is located within flood zone 1.

7.1.3 The exception and sequential test is not required.

7.1.4 Other sources of flooding have been deemed as either Very low or unlikely.

7.1.5 No flood mitigation is required for this change of use planning application

7.1.6 The development is not considered to be at unacceptable risk of flooding during its lifetime and therefore should not be objected to on flood risk grounds.

7.1.7 The future occupants and users of the proposed development will be safe from flooding and there will be no detrimental impact on third parties. The proposal complies with the NPPF and local planning policy with respect to flood risk and is an appropriate development at the location.

APPENDIX 1 LOCATION PLAN

RGP

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